Clifford Bressette

IBM DataPower & API Connect | OpenShift | Ansible | Python | Agentic Guardrails | PKI & Post-Quantum Readiness

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Professional Summary

Senior architect with 13+ years automating and modernizing IBM DataPower and API Connect estates for Fortune 100 clients in financial services and healthcare. Supported the migration of DataPower and APIC to Red Hat OpenShift with Ansible automation, helped build Python tooling that managed 300+ appliances, has run managed DataPower engineering for a Blue Cross Blue Shield care-management platform since 2017, and authored MAST, a DataPower automation toolkit licensed by a Big Four firm for eleven years. Deep in PKI, certificate lifecycle and secrets management, now applied to post-quantum readiness and AI agent security.

Professional Experience

Senior Architect, Product Development Lead and Principal Consultant | McIndi Solutions LLC | 2026 – Present

- Delivering post-quantum cryptography (PQC) readiness work, including certificate and key inventory automation across DataPower estates, and migrations of DataPower and API Connect to cloud-native platforms
- **Project Catalyst** (IBM TechXchange 2026, session TEC-2557, with iSOA Group and IBM): built the deployment methodology, Helm charts, CRDs, and integrations that run IBM Research's Rossoctl on OpenShift with runtime guardrails: SPIFFE/SPIRE identity, Vault just-in-time secrets, Keycloak OIDC, an Istio MCP gateway, and intent-based egress enforcement audited in SIEMatic
- **Release engineering** for McIndi's open-source tools: tag-driven GitHub Actions pipelines that publish Python packages to PyPI through trusted publishing after a TestPyPI run (Adapt, Trailhead, runit), build multi-arch container images for GHCR with SBOM and build-provenance attestations, push a Helm chart to an OCI registry, and gate image pushes on integration tests

Consultant | Engagements delivered through McIndi Solutions | 2013 – 2026

Engaged as an independent contractor to McIndi (2013, 2016 – 2017), through my own firm, B&B Technology Services (2013 – 2016), and as a W-2 employee of Innovation Focused, Inc. (2017 – 2026).

Care-management platform serving Blue Cross Blue Shield plans (2017 – Present). Managed IBM DataPower engineering since the initial 2017 implementation, as the on-call DataPower SME keeping the platform's gateway tier stable.

- Handle firmware upgrades, appliance monitoring, certificate renewals, and troubleshooting
- Delivered a healthcare provider integration through DataPower

CVS Health / Aetna: IT Modernization & Cloud Migration (2019 – 2024). Senior engineer on an 8-member Agile team supporting the migration of DataPower and API Connect to Red Hat OpenShift across VMware, Azure, and GCP.

- Cut deployment time 50% and improved uptime by supporting Ansible automation deploying and configuring DataPower and APIC on OpenShift
- Supported a Python framework monitoring and managing 300+ DataPower appliances, which reduced MTTR by over 40%

Big Four Professional Services Firm: Access Control & Data Protection (2019 – 2022)

- Created and supported a secure Django REST Framework API for creating, testing, and deploying Kerberos keytabs, reducing manual intervention 80%
- Created and supported the automation of enterprise-wide encryption standard updates across DataPower with Python and Django
- Cut manual effort 90% and deployment errors 60% by automating DataPower service deployment in Python

MAST for IBM DataPower (2015 – 2026). Authored MAST, a DataPower fleet automation toolkit licensed by a Big Four firm from 2015 to 2026.

Technical Skills

- **API Gateways & Cloud:** IBM DataPower, API Connect, Envoy Gateway, OpenShift, Kubernetes, Helm, Ansible, Podman, Docker, RHEL
- **Security & PKI:** X.509 lifecycle, private CAs, PQC readiness, TLS/mTLS, OAuth 2.0/OIDC, Keycloak, Vault/OpenBao, SPIFFE/SPIRE, Kerberos, cert-manager
- **Development:** Python, Django/DRF, FastAPI, XSLT, JavaScript, SQL/PostgreSQL, Celery, Redis, Splunk, GitHub Actions, Jenkins
- **Release Engineering:** GitHub Actions, PyPI trusted publishing, GHCR multi-arch images, Helm charts (OCI), SBOM and build provenance
- **Practices:** pytest, Playwright, TDD, Agile/Scrum, Git workflows

Selected Open-Source Projects

- **MAST for IBM DataPower**: fleet automation: backups, deployments, config management, cert audits, web UI
- **SIEMatic**: Django security observability: agents, indexer, search language, dashboards, alerts
- **PKI Workbench**: X.509 certificate lifecycle, private CAs, and PQC readiness

Education

Lackawanna College | 2008 – 2010 — Associate's Degree, Computer Information Systems